



SYSTEMS

Main systems:

1. Divine Energy System

- Using powers increases **Divine Energy**
- High levels cause:
 - Crop mutation
 - Soil corruption
 - Curse events
- If it maxes out → triggers instability / possible Rampage

2. Boredom System

- Repeating farming tasks builds **Boredom**
- When full:
 - Divine Energy leaks automatically
 - Villagers grow fearful
 - Player loses control options
- Unlocks **Rampage Mode**

3. Farming System

- Tile-based rice planting
- Irrigation control mechanics
- Seasonal crop growth:
 - Spring → planting
 - Summer → growth
 - Autumn → harvest
 - Winter → reset
- Tools consume stamina → pacing mechanic

4. Relationship System

- NPCs react dynamically based on:
 - Power usage (restraint vs abuse)
 - Dialogue choices
 - Farming behavior
- Daughter (Jojo) acts as emotional anchor
- Can influence ending outcomes

5. Rampage System

- Activated when control is lost (Boredom + Energy)
- 60-second destruction sequence
- World shifts:
 - Audio → horror tone
 - Visuals → dark/red palette overlay on the screen + shaky camera
- Outcomes:
 - Sealed by exorcists
 - Total destruction

6. Morality / Choice System

- No “fail state” → only consequences
- Every action pushes toward:
 - Peaceful farmer
 - Unstable deity
 - Full destruction path
- Determines ending + village state

7. Progression System

- Multiple endings:
 - Peaceful life [good ending]
 - Sealed god [bad ending]
 - Dominant dark god [rampage mode]
- Replayability through different behavior patterns
- Story progresses through player using these named systems above

Combat, Economy, Progression:

Combat

Combat in *Oni no Ta* is not constant, but exists as a consequence of losing restraint. When Divine Energy and Boredom spiral out of control, the player enters **Rampage Mode**, unleashing destructive power against the village and incoming exorcists. Rather than skill-based fighting, combat is chaotic, time-limited, and emotionally driven → emphasizing **loss of control over mastery**.

Economy

The economy is rooted in **rice farming and village relationships** rather than currency. Players manage resources like crops, time, and effort, while social trust acts as an invisible currency. Helping villagers and maintaining balance **improves cooperation and rewards**, while reckless behavior leads to fear, isolation, and fewer **opportunities**.

Progression

Progression is driven by **player behavior and moral choices**, not levels or stats. As players choose restraint or indulgence, the world, characters, and outcomes evolve. Multiple endings and changing village states create a **branching experience**, encouraging **replayability** through different paths rather than **linear advancement**.

BOREDOM SYSTEM

RELATIONSHIP SYSTEM

Overview

The Relationship System in *Oni no Ta* is a dynamic, behavior-driven social simulation that reflects the player's moral alignment and use of divine power. Rather than relying on static dialogue trees or simple affinity meters, relationships evolve through observed player actions, emotional consistency, and long-term behavioral patterns. This system transforms NPCs from passive quest-givers into reactive agents, making the village feel alive and morally responsive.

Core Design Philosophy

- Relationships are earned through behavior (AI involved maybe), not choices alone
- NPCs observe patterns, not isolated events
- Emotional responses are gradual and layered, not binary
- Trust can be built → but also permanently broken

Key Components

1. Hidden Trust Matrix

Each NPC has multiple internal values:

- **Trust** (Do they feel safe around you?)
- **Respect** (Do they see you as disciplined or dangerous?)
- **Fear** (Are you becoming a threat?)
- **Attachment** (Emotional bond, especially with Jojo)

These values:

- Change **continuously over time**
- Are influenced by **player actions, not just dialogue**
- Interact with each other (e.g., high fear reduces trust growth)

2. Behavioral Tracking System

NPCs evaluate the player based on patterns such as:

- Frequency of divine power usage
- Willingness to complete mundane farming tasks
- Consistency (calm vs erratic behavior)
- Response to stressful situations (restraint vs indulgence)

This creates:

- A sense that NPCs are “**watching and remembering**”
- Consequences that feel **earned, not scripted**

3. Dynamic NPC Reactions

NPC behavior evolves across multiple layers:

Low Fear / High Trust

- Friendly dialogue
- Gifts or assistance
- Open body language and proximity

Neutral State

- Polite but distant
- Limited interaction depth

High Fear / Low Trust

- Avoidance or silence
- Rumors spreading in village
- Physical distancing or hiding

Extreme State

- Villagers call exorcists
- Social collapse of the village
- Locks certain endings

4. Jojo (Daughter) – Emotional Anchor

Jojo acts as a **moral mirror** of the player.

- Her behavior reflects your alignment:
 - Gentle → hopeful, trusting
 - Violent → fearful, withdrawn
- She can:
 - Stabilize the player emotionally (reduce escalation)
 - Influence key narrative decisions
 - Serve as the **primary emotional stake** in the story

This ensures the system isn't just mechanical, it's **personally meaningful**.

Gameplay Impact

- Alters dialogue availability
- Unlocks or locks story branches
- Changes village atmosphere (alive vs empty)
- Directly influences endings

General System

This system creates:

- **Emotional retention** → players care about outcomes
- **Replayability** → different behavior = different world
- **Narrative depth without heavy content cost** → systems generate variety

It replaces traditional quest design with **emergent storytelling**, reducing production overhead while increasing player engagement.